

A WORKED CASE · FOR DISCUSSION, NOT ADOPTION

RFI and submittal drafting

Every project runs on paper that has to move fast: RFIs, submittals, change orders. A project manager loses hours each week writing and chasing them, and a slow or sloppy one stalls a trade or buries a claim. Most of it is drafting from documents you already have on hand. This pilot asks a narrow question: can a first-draft assistant, with the PM still editing and sending every item, give that time back without giving up accuracy?

THE PILOT (BOUNDARY)

One active project, one PM. The assistant drafts; the PM reviews, edits, and sends every item. Nothing reaches an architect or sub on its own.

INTENT

Give a project manager hours back each week on routine correspondence, with no loss of accuracy.

DATA IT MAY USE

Your own project documents: plans, specs, the submittal log, prior RFIs and responses, the contract you already hold.

DATA IT NEVER TOUCHES

Anything outside this project, privileged claim strategy, or personal information. Drafts stay internal until the PM approves.

VALUE / IMPACT

300

high impact

TIME TO VALUE

4 WEEKS

one project, one PM

LOOK HERE FIRST

75

$300 \div 4$

PRESSURE-TEST IT · ATTACK THE IDEA, NOT THE PERSON

- 1 When the assistant misreads a spec, how does the PM catch it before it leaves the office?
- 2 Who is accountable for the final wording on a change order, the PM or the tool?
- 3 How do you measure the win: hours saved, faster turnaround, or fewer reopened items?
- 4 What is the stopping line if a draft creates more rework than it saves?

A WORKED CASE · FOR DISCUSSION, NOT ADOPTION

Bid and estimate support

Winning work starts with the estimate, and estimating is slow, detailed, and easy to get wrong under a deadline. AI can help read plans, pull quantities, and draft first-pass scope and proposal language, with your estimator checking every number. The payoff is real, but plans are messy and the stakes are higher than routine paperwork, so this one takes longer to trust. That is exactly why it is the second pilot, not the first.

THE PILOT (BOUNDARY)

One bid, one estimator. The tool supports takeoff and drafts scope language; the estimator owns every quantity and price. No bid leaves unchecked.

INTENT

Produce a faster, more complete first-pass estimate so your team can bid more work without adding people.

DATA IT MAY USE

The plans and specs for this bid, your historical cost data, your standard scope language.

DATA IT NEVER TOUCHES

Competitor information, and any final bid number shared outside the team before review.

VALUE / IMPACT

400

very high

TIME TO VALUE

8 WEEKS

plans need prep

LOOK HERE FIRST

50

$400 \div 8$

PRESSURE-TEST IT · ATTACK THE IDEA, NOT THE PERSON

- 1 Where is the line between a helpful takeoff and a quantity nobody double-checked?
- 2 What happens when the plans are incomplete, or contradict the specs?
- 3 Who signs off on the quantities before they ever reach a price?
- 4 Is the time saved real, or did checking the machine eat it back?

Notice the two scores. Estimating wins on value (400 to 300), but it takes twice as long, so $400 \div 8 = 50$ lands below the paperwork's $300 \div 4 = 75$. High value alone does not win. Value over time does.

YOUR CASE · FRAME IT THE SAME WAY

In two or three lines, set the scene the way the worked cases do: what happens today, why it costs you, and the narrow question this pilot asks.

THE PILOT (BOUNDARY)

INTENT

DATA IT MAY USE

DATA IT NEVER TOUCHES

VALUE / IMPACT
HIGH / MED / LOW

TIME TO VALUE
__ WEEKS

LOOK HERE FIRST

value ÷ duration

OTHER CANDIDATES FROM YOUR WORLD · PICK ONE THAT IS SMALL AND FREQUENT

- PRECONSTRUCTION

 - Bid scope drafting
 - Takeoff support from plans
 - Sub bid leveling
 - Prequalification summaries
- PROJECT EXECUTION

 - RFI and submittal drafting
 - Daily reports from field notes
 - Schedule look-ahead narratives
 - Meeting-minute summaries
- SAFETY & INSIGHT

 - Incident-report patterns
 - Auto-generated toolbox talks
 - Punch-list and closeout summaries
 - Benchmark your numbers vs peers